thought of drinking a warm energy drink for the rest of my career would've done my bladdy head in.

It didn't take too long before it was 'later for that' to the Energade and I was back, doing proper justice to a fines meeting. Later, before the Cape Cobras Pro20 final against the Diamond Eagles at Newlands, I promised myself that even if we won the game in front of our home crowd, I would refrain from joining my Cobras teammates in the traditional beer-soaked celebrations.

I couldn't do it, though. I couldn't keep my promise. We ended up winning and, predictably, the beers were flying in the changing room. I reasoned with myself: 'Well, okay, we did win after all. I might as well tonk a few beers too.'

It was a great evening. We had a fines meeting and drank and drank. Professor André Odendaal, the Western Province Cricket CEO, came into the room at one point and I said, 'Doc …' (I always called him Doc.) 'Doc, I think we're going to need some more beer here.' And the beers just kept coming. We went out afterwards and had a big night.

The next morning I hated myself for going overboard. This was six or seven weeks after I had left the clinic, and sitting in my car the next morning, I was thinking, 'Why the hell did you do it? Like, why did you do this?' For many, if not most people, once they've come out of rehab, they manage to stay away from alcohol for the rest of their lives. I take my hat off to them, but that's not me, I'm afraid. Even though I was upset with myself for getting drunk, I also knew that I would probably never be able to give up drinking entirely. Not even in rehab did I say that I was never going to touch a drop of alcohol again.

But rehab allowed me to see what I was like when alcohol ruled my life, and it showed me how it affected those close to me. I won't let that happen again. But I'm still going to drink like the average person. I see no reason why I have to stop completely.

So I give it the proper horns on the odd occasion, but I also have nights when I go down to Caprice, where I've had many serious piss-ups, and drink no more than a couple of strong cappuccinos. And I still find it a highly enjoyable experience. I might go down to the bar to watch a Champion's League football game – I'm a lifelong Manchester United fan – and have a cool time just drinking coffee. The simple fact is that I've cut down on my alcohol consumption by a huge amount.